



ENERGY WATCH

POLESTAR INSIGHTS

REPORTING PERIOD: 4 SEPTEMBER 2026 - 10 SEPTEMBER 2026

FAST FACTS

REPORTING PERIOD 4 Sep - 10 Sep 2026	MOST AFFECTED COUNTRY Philippines 26 records	POWER SUPPLY Longer brownouts Cebu faces longer brownouts as Visayas power shortage worsens
INFRASTRUCTURE OUTAGE Substation fire Substation fire cuts power to parts of Dhaka for hours	ELECTRICITY COSTS Higher electricity costs Brownouts now, higher Visayas power bills in September	BUSINESS IMPACT Market vendors affected Colon Night Market vendors grapple with rotational brownouts

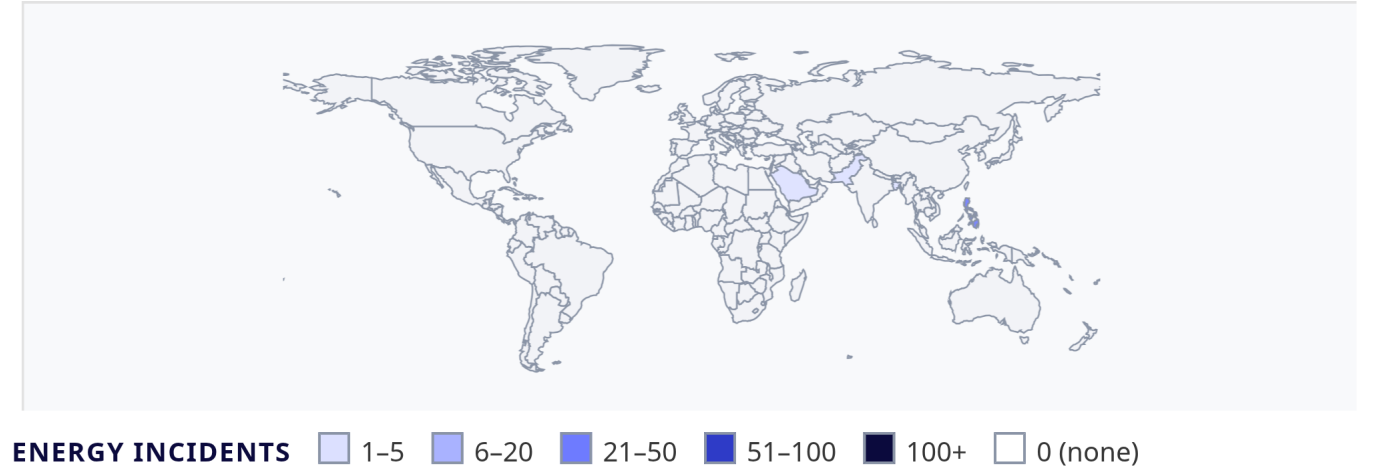
BLUF

Grid risk this week is a reliability-and-continuity story rather than a single dramatic failure. The pressure came from load shedding, power outage and substation incident. Philippines carried the most visible grid strain, alongside Bangladesh and Pakistan. The most serious reached high.

Behind the individual events sits the structural picture: thin generation margins, ageing transmission and a heavy dependence on fuel-to-power supply that turns a hot afternoon or a tripped substation into hours of lost load. Outages, load shedding and shortfall are the symptoms; the underlying weakness is a grid with little room to absorb a shock.

For business users the implication is operational, not abstract: unplanned downtime, generator hours and the running cost of keeping critical sites lit. Backup power, fuel cover for extended outages and a clear view of single-source grid dependence are the measures that earn their keep while this picture holds.

ENERGY SITUATION



MARKET PRICES

ELECTRICITY (US CITY AVG)

US city average retail electricity

0.197 USD/kWh

-0.5% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · BLS / FRED (APU000072610)

NATURAL GAS (EUROPE)

EU import natural gas

17.93 USD/MMBtu

+18.8% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PNGASEUUSDM)

NATURAL GAS (HENRY HUB)

Henry Hub natural gas spot

2.810 USD/MMBtu

-2.4% 7d



As of 09 Sep 2026 · EIA / FRED (DHHNGSP)

THERMAL COAL (AUSTRALIA)

Australian thermal coal

140.4 USD/mt

-6.6% MoM



As of Jul 2026 · IMF / FRED (PCOALAUUSDM)

ENERGY SITUATION

PHILIPPINES / VISAYAS

Capacity margins stay thin and fuel-to-power supply remains the underlying weakness, so the grid has little headroom when demand peaks or a feeder trips. This matters because reliability and cost move together here: every hour of lost load is both a continuity problem and a generator-fuel bill, and long restorations turn a brief dip into real operational disruption. Philippines sits at the centre of the current reporting.

Reporting centred on load shedding, power outage and substation incident. Reporting concentrated on Philippines, with more from Bangladesh and Pakistan. The most serious reached high.

WHAT MATTERS

Reliability gaps land first on site uptime and generator load, then on the running cost of business continuity. When outages run long the cost shifts from inconvenience to fuel burn, spoiled stock, missed production and overtime to recover. Exposure to Philippines is the live pressure point for backup power, generator fuel and continuity spend.

Where weak generation margins meet a transmission fault or a fuel-supply squeeze, the impact compounds: load shedding deepens, restoration slows, and sites on a single grid feed lose the buffer they assumed they had. That is the exposure worth planning against now, rather than after the next peak-demand failure.

IMPLICATIONS FOR BUSINESS

- Check backup generator cover and service status against a multi-hour outage, not just a brief dip.
- Hold fuel stock for extended generator runtime wherever the public grid is the only feed.
- Confirm UPS run-time and failover on critical loads - servers, cold chain, life-safety and security systems.
- Map single-source dependence on the public grid and line up alternate supply or on-site generation before the next peak.
- Build outage cost into continuity budgets - fuel burn, spoilage, lost production and recovery overtime add up fast on long restorations.

WATCH NEXT

- Load-shedding schedules - fresh rationing notices are the clearest sign generation margins are tightening.
- Substation and transmission faults - repeat trips on the same network point to ageing infrastructure, not one-off events.
- Fuel-to-power supply - gas, diesel and coal availability decides whether plants can actually run to capacity.
- Peak-demand weather - heatwaves and cold snaps push demand past the margin and trigger shedding.
- Generation outages and maintenance - planned and forced unit outages tighten the supply buffer within days.

POLESTAR VIEW

Energy Watch is flagging standing grid fragility rather than a single dramatic failure. The risk is structural - thin generation margins and heavy fuel-to-power dependence - so the operational answer is resilience: backup power, fuel cover and a clear view of single-grid dependence. Philippines is the clearest country pressure point, with the rest of the picture filled in by Bangladesh and Pakistan.

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